An **Acceleration Program** is fundamentally different from an Incubation Program.

An incubation application asks:

"Do you have a promising idea?"

An acceleration application asks:

"Can your business scale, and are you ready for growth and investment?"

Therefore, the registration form should collect **much deeper operational, financial, market, and growth data**.

Dynamic Stage-Based Acceleration Program Registration

Section 1: Business Growth Stage Assessment (Dynamic Onboarding)

Purpose

Determine whether the startup is suitable for an acceleration program.

Eligible Business Stages

Applicants should select one of:

- Early Startup
- Growth Stage
- Scale-Up Stage
- Investment Ready Stage

Display a short explanation for each stage.

If "Early Startup" is Selected

Display:

Current Status

- Product launched?
- Number of customers
- Paying customers

- Monthly revenue
- Business registration status

Current Challenges

- Customer acquisition
- Marketing
- Team building
- Cash flow
- Product refinement

Goal During Acceleration

- Increase customers
- Increase revenue
- Improve operations
- Prepare for scaling

If "Growth Stage" is Selected

Display:

- Revenue growth
- Customer growth
- Team size
- New markets entered
- Operational challenges
- Growth priorities

If "Scale-Up Stage" is Selected

Display:

- Countries/regions served
- Distribution channels
- Number of branches
- Existing partnerships
- Operational systems
- Leadership structure

If "Investment Ready" is Selected

Display:

- Funding required
- Previous investments

- Investor meetings
- Business valuation
- Financial projections
- Pitch readiness

Section 2: Founder & Leadership Team

Unlike incubation, acceleration evaluates the **leadership team's ability to scale**.

Founder Details

- Founder name
- Position
- Education
- Entrepreneurial experience
- Years of industry experience

Leadership Team

For each executive:

- Name
- Position
- Department
- Years of experience
- Key responsibilities

Examples:

- CEO
- COO
- CTO
- CFO
- Marketing Lead
- Sales Lead

Section 3: Company Information

Collect:

- Business name
- Registration number
- Tax identification number
- Date established

- Country of incorporation
- Industry
- Sector
- Business model
- Website
- Social media links

Section 4: Product & Service Portfolio

Capture:

- Products/services offered
- Product maturity
- Unique value proposition
- Intellectual property (patents, trademarks, copyrights)
- Technology used

Upload:

- Product catalogue
- Product photos
- Demo videos
- Product brochures

Section 5: Market & Customer Information

Understand the startup's commercial traction.

Collect:

Customers

- Total customers
- Paying customers
- Enterprise customers
- Customer retention rate

Markets

- Local
- Regional
- International

Customer Segments

- B2B
- B2C
- Government
- NGOs

Competitors

- Main competitors
- Competitive advantage
- Market share estimate

Section 6: Business Performance

This is the heart of an acceleration application.

Collect:

Revenue

- Monthly revenue
- Annual revenue
- Revenue growth (%)
- Revenue sources

Sales

- Average monthly sales
- Largest customer
- Repeat customers

Financial Health

- Gross profit
- Net profit
- Cash flow status

Section 7: Growth Metrics (KPIs)

Collect operational indicators such as:

Business KPIs

- Customers acquired
- Customer retention

- Annual recurring revenue (if applicable)
- Conversion rate
- Average order value

Employment KPIs

- Full-time employees
- Part-time employees
- Interns
- Contractors

Impact KPIs

- Jobs created
- Women employed
- Youth employed
- Beneficiaries served

Section 8: Operations & Scalability

Assess whether the business can grow sustainably.

Collect:

- Current production capacity
- Monthly production volume
- Supply chain partners
- Manufacturing capability
- Inventory management
- Quality assurance systems
- Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs)

Section 9: Digital Transformation

Determine digital maturity.

Collect:

- Website available?
- Mobile app?
- ERP system?
- CRM system?
- Accounting software?
- E-commerce platform?

- Digital marketing tools?

Section 10: Investment Readiness

This section is unique to acceleration.

Collect:

Funding

- Funding amount required
- Type of funding sought (Grant, Equity, Debt, Convertible Note)
- Purpose of funding
- Funding timeline

Existing Investment

- Previous grants
- Angel investment
- Venture capital
- Loans
- Bootstrapped

Business Valuation

- Estimated valuation
- Cap table
- Shareholding structure

Section 11: Financial Information

Upload:

- Income Statement
- Balance Sheet
- Cash Flow Statement
- Bank Statements
- Tax Returns
- Financial Projections (3–5 years)
- Budget Forecast

Section 12: Growth Challenges Assessment

Ask applicants to identify their biggest barriers.

Examples:

- Sales
- Marketing
- Hiring
- Operations
- Leadership
- Technology
- Finance
- Export
- Manufacturing
- Regulatory compliance

Applicants should rank their top priorities.

Section 13: Acceleration Needs Assessment

What support are you seeking?

Options include:

- Scaling Strategy
- Market Expansion
- Export Readiness
- Investment Readiness
- Financial Modelling
- Sales Strategy
- Leadership Development
- Corporate Governance
- Process Improvement
- Product Scaling
- Strategic Partnerships
- Technology Adoption

This drives personalized support plans.

Section 14: Mentor & Advisor Matching

Collect preferences for mentors with expertise in:

- Scaling Businesses
- Fundraising

- Venture Capital
- International Markets
- Manufacturing
- Technology
- Legal & Compliance
- Corporate Governance
- Human Resources
- Digital Transformation

Section 15: Business Growth Goals

Applicants define measurable objectives, for example:

- Double revenue
- Enter two new markets
- Raise investment
- Hire ten employees
- Increase exports
- Launch a new product
- Secure strategic partnerships

Section 16: Monitoring & Evaluation (Baseline)

Capture current values for:

Financial

- Annual revenue
- Profit
- Investment raised

Employment

- Total employees
- Women employed
- Youth employed

Market

- Number of customers
- Countries served
- Distribution channels

Innovation

- Products
- Patents
- R&D activities

These figures become the baseline for measuring the impact of the acceleration programme.

Section 17: Supporting Documents

The required documents should adapt to the selected business stage but may include:

Company Documents

- Certificate of Incorporation
- Tax Registration Certificate
- Business Licenses

Financial Documents

- Audited Financial Statements (if available)
- Management Accounts
- Cash Flow Statements
- Financial Projections

Business Documents

- Pitch Deck
- Business Plan
- Strategic Plan
- Marketing Plan

Product Documents

- Product Catalogue
- Product Demonstration
- Intellectual Property Documentation

Investment Documents

- Cap Table
- Shareholder Register
- Existing Investment Agreements

Section 18: Terms, Consent & Declaration

Applicants confirm:

- Information provided is accurate.
- Financial information is truthful.
- They agree to programme terms and conditions.
- They consent to data processing and monitoring.

Section 19: Review & Submission

Before submission, present a comprehensive summary:

- ✓ Founder Profile Complete
- ✓ Company Information Complete
- ✓ Financial Information Complete
- ✓ Growth Metrics Complete
- ✓ Investment Readiness Complete
- ✓ Required Documents Uploaded
- ✓ Growth Goals Defined

Generate an **Acceleration Readiness Score** based on completeness and diagnostic responses. If the score is low, recommend actions such as improving financial records, strengthening governance, or refining the investment pitch before final submission.